

MATH

Multiplication Strategy Sheet

Covers skip counting, arrays, and the standard algorithm — a reliable homework reference card.

There are several reliable ways to solve a multiplication problem. Your child doesn't need to master all of them at once — the goal is to have at least one strategy that works confidently, plus exposure to the others.

1. Skip Counting

Count up by the same number repeatedly. Best for smaller facts.

Example: $4 \times 6 \rightarrow 6, 12, 18, 24, 30, 36$ (six jumps of 6) = 24... count six groups of 4: 4, 8, 12, 16, 20, 24 $\rightarrow$ answer 24.

2. Arrays / Groups

Draw rows and columns of dots or objects. The total number of dots is the product.

Example: 4×6 is drawn as 4 rows of 6 dots (or 6 rows of 4) — 24 dots total.

3. Standard Algorithm

Multiply digit by digit, carrying and regrouping as needed — used for larger numbers.

$$\begin{array}{r} 23 \\ \times 4 \\ \hline 92 \end{array}$$

$23 \times 4 = 92$ ($4 \times 3 = 12$, carry 1; $4 \times 2 = 8$, $+1 = 9$)

Which strategy when?

- Small numbers, building understanding $\rightarrow$ skip counting or arrays.
- Larger numbers, working efficiently $\rightarrow$ standard algorithm.
- Checking an answer $\rightarrow$ try a second strategy and compare.